

WORKING WITH COLLEAGUES

Collaborative Working Relationship

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Introduction

- ❑ Collaboration can be defined as high-level cooperativeness and assertiveness to solve the problem where there are common interests.
- ❑ With whom do we need to collaborate?
 - Other health care professionals, including Pharmacy practitioners

Cont...

Why collaboration ?

- The aging population and increased burden of chronic diseases which need collaborative management
- Increased incidence of drug misadventure
- Poor communication among practitioners was the most important common factor contributing to medication errors.

Cont...

- This led to the concept of medication therapy management(MTM)
- MT Programs are “designed” to “optimize therapeutic outcomes through improved medication use” and “reduce the risk of adverse events.”
 - Objectives are to increase patient adherence, prevent drug complications, and enhance patient understanding of their medication therapy.

Cont...

- MTM program established for targeted beneficiaries such as those
 - Who have multiple chronic disease states
 - Who are taking multiple drugs
 - Who are likely to incur annual costs of at least \$4,000.
- This program is typical example of services that needs collaboration among practitioners particularly physicians and pharmacists

The benefit of collaborative relationships

- It enables prevention of medication related errors and reduce drug costs
- To deal with a health issues that are too complex for one health professional to handle
- Leads to increase patient's adherence
- To avoid confrontational relationships and procedural obstacles between pharmacists and physicians

How to establish effective collaboration?

Four Key Characteristics of Effective Collaboration

- **Sharing:** includes sharing of responsibilities, philosophies of health care, values, planning, interventions, and commitment to patient-centered care.
- **Partnering:** implies that two or more people will join together in a collegial, authentic, and productive relationship characterized by honest communication, mutual trust, and respect.

Cont...

- **Interdependency:** refers to the fact that professionals are interdependent, rather than autonomous, as they work toward meeting patient needs
- **Power:** is seen as being shared among partners with empowerment accorded to all participants. Sharing of power is based on knowledge and skill

Factors that influences collaboration

❖ Participants characteristics

- ✓ Individual characteristics (e.g. age, Knowledge, confidence, attitude and belief)
- ✓ Professional experience (e.g. GP vs specialty, familiarity with other professionals, education)

❖ Context characteristics

- ✓ Patients mix
- ✓ Proximity of practice
- ✓ Volume of interaction
- ✓ System relationship

Cont...

❖ Exchange characteristics

- ✓ Attraction: certain characteristics or circumstances may cause providers to professionally attracted to each other.
- ✓ Openness and bi-directionality of communication: communicate with each other in an open manner.
- ✓ Power and justice: ability of one provider to influence another and the fairness of the exchange (costs and benefits).
- ✓ Norm development: Norms develop over time as providers become more comfortable with each other professionally.

Cont...

✓ **Exchange characteristics....**

- ✓ Expectation development: As providers begin to exchange information, they will begin to form expectations about the other's abilities and competence.
- ✓ Performance assessment: As expectations develop, providers will begin to assess the performance of others.
- ✓ Conflict and its resolution: Resolving conflicts through open discussion allows the relationship to strengthen.

Barriers to collaborative relationship

- Boundary concern---the attitudes of some providers that giving pharmacists a greater role in drug therapy decision-making invades upon the provider's broad patient care powers and erodes some of their autonomy.
- Communication breaks
- Lack of trust in another practitioner's competences
- Practice site distant from one another

Cont...

- Lack of clear definitions for collaborations so that effective communication among stakeholders cannot occur
- Lack of a supportive culture at the public, institutional, professional, and agency levels
- Lack of a supportive regulatory and statutory system, so that clear articulation of professional responsibilities
- Lack of economic incentives to reward collaborating professionals who see the benefits of collaboration

Cont...

- Lack of educational programs that encourage health professionals to work collaboratively.
- Lack of understanding by patients about the benefit of collaborative care, which leads to decreased demand for collaborative care
- Lack of communication technology to allow partners to easily communicate with each other.

Model for pharmacist- physicians collaborative working relationship

Initial Steps

- Understand the local situation
- When interacting with physicians, always remember that time is extremely important to them, so use it efficiently and wisely.
- Focus on building a trustworthy relationship
- Experience has shown that effective collaborative relationships are built on trust and commitment

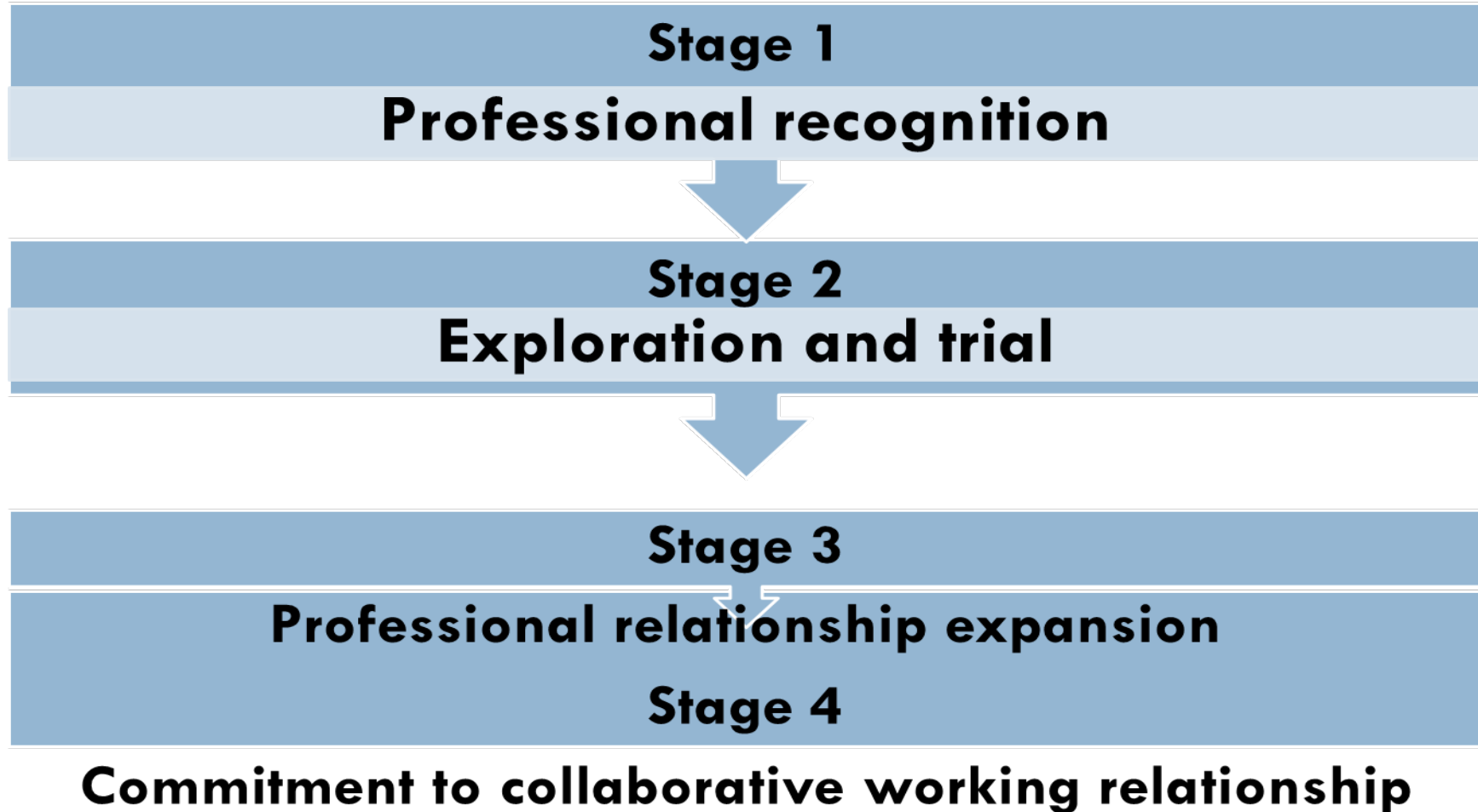
Cont...

- Trust is built by the confidence one has in another person's predictable behavior
- The specific behaviors in trusting relationships were that both parties:
 - ✓ Search for input from one another,
 - ✓ Allowed each other to do their jobs without unnecessary oversight,
 - ✓ Openly discussed success and failure and learned from both

Critical behaviors in a collaborative relationship

- ☐ Relationships have long-term and short-term agendas
- ☐ Relationships are nonhierarchical and based on equality
- ☐ Considering patient perspectives
- ☐ Trust and shared visions are central to these relationships
- ☐ Relationships should demonstrate respect for the culture of each professional
- ☐ Collaborative relationships should be voluntary

Model for pharmacist-physicians' collaborative working relationship



Cont...

Stage 1- unilateral effort to establish relationship

■ Strategies

- Communicate with targeted physicians to inform them of interest in collaborating.
- Identify pharmacy services that can complement the physician's practice while also meeting patients needs.
- Discuss ideas with physicians to judge their interest.
- Refine ideas to meet the needs of physicians with whom the potential for a collaborative working relationship exists.
- Schedule another face-to-face meeting with the goal of starting to build a collaborative working relationship.

Cont...

Stage 2- Exploration and Trial

- During this stage, practitioners gauge and test their compatibility, expectations, trustworthiness, and commitment to the relationship.
- Pharmacists continue to be the initiators as physicians consider their obligations as well as the benefits and risks of collaboration.

Cont...

■ Strategies

- Make only high-quality, high-priority recommendations to physicians.
- Get physicians feedback about recommendations
- Document the outcomes of recommendations.
- Discuss with the physician the best way to communicate recommendations (e.g., telephone call, fax, progress note, or a combination of these).

Cont...

Stage 3- Professional Relationship Expansion

- Seeing a continued increase in benefits from the exploration and trial stage can lead practitioners to increase interdependence and expand professional relationships

Cont...

■ Strategies

- Communicate to referring physicians the patient outcomes that have resulted from pharmacy care interventions.
- Be consistent in provision of care to patients. Continue to make high-quality clinical interventions,
- Have periodic face-to-face meetings with physicians to establish and enhance personal and professional relationship.
- Identify any conflicts due to pharmacy care interventions and discuss strategies to resolve them.

Cont...

Stage 4- bilateral commitment for maintenance of the relationship

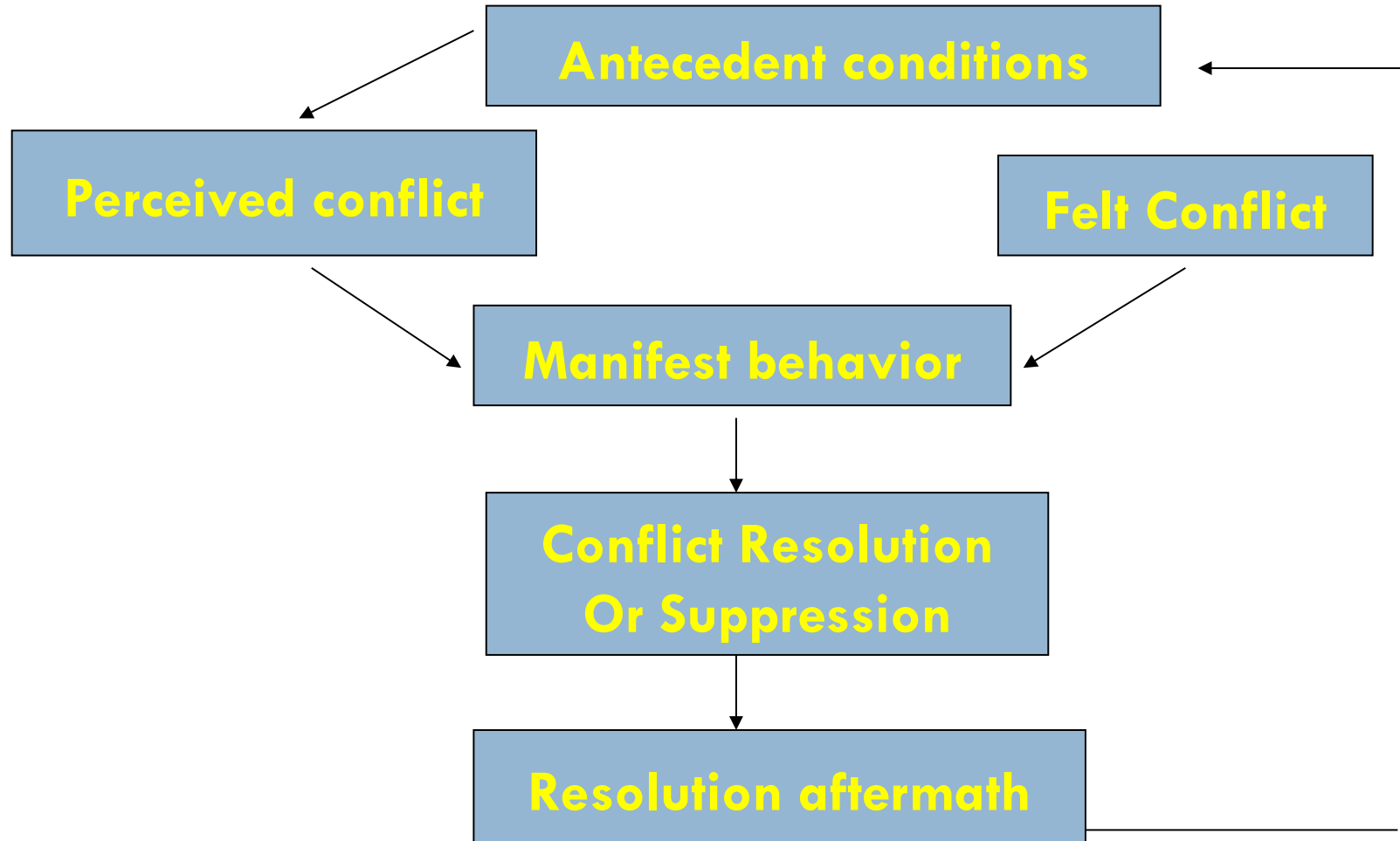
- Collaboration is more likely to occur when physicians view the risk to their own practice as low and the value added as high.
- For commitment in a relationship to exist, at the very least, all of the following elements must be present:
 - ✓ relatively high input levels by the parties,
 - ✓ relatively lengthy duration,
 - ✓ relatively great consistency

Conflict Management

What is conflict?

- ❑ A battle, contest or opposing forces existing between primitive desires and moral, religious or ethical ideas
- ❑ A state of incompatibility of ideas between two or more parties or individuals
- ❑ Conflict management is the practice of identifying and handling conflict in a sensible, fair and efficient manner

Conflict Process



Conflict process...

❖ Antecedent Conditions

- Scarce Resources
- Conflicting attitude
- Ambiguous jurisdiction
- Communication barriers
- Unresolved prior conflicts
- Knowledge of self and others
- Poorly defined goals
- Divergent personal values
- Lack of cooperation/trust
- Unclear roles/lack of job description

Conflict process...

❖ Perceived conflict

- Become aware that one is in conflict with another party. It is possible to block out some conflict

❖ Felt conflict

- Emotional part of conflict
- Personalizing the conflict
- Oral and physical hostility
- Hard to manage episodes with high felt conflict

Levels and Types of Conflict

Level of conflict

Type of conflict

Organization

→ Within and between organizations

Group

→ Within and between groups

Individual

→ Within and between individuals

Cont...

❖ **Intra-organization conflict**

- Conflict that occurs within an organization
- At interfaces of organization functions
- Can occur along the vertical and horizontal dimensions of the organization
 - **Vertical conflict:** between managers and subordinates
 - **Horizontal conflict:** between departments and work groups

Cont...

❖ **Intragroup conflict**

- ✓ Conflict among members of a group
- ✓ Ways of doing tasks or reaching the group's goals

❖ **Intergroup conflict:** between two or more groups

❖ **Interpersonal conflict**

- ✓ Between two or more people
- ✓ Differences in views about what should be done
- ✓ Efforts to get more resources

Cont...

❖ **Inter-organization conflict**

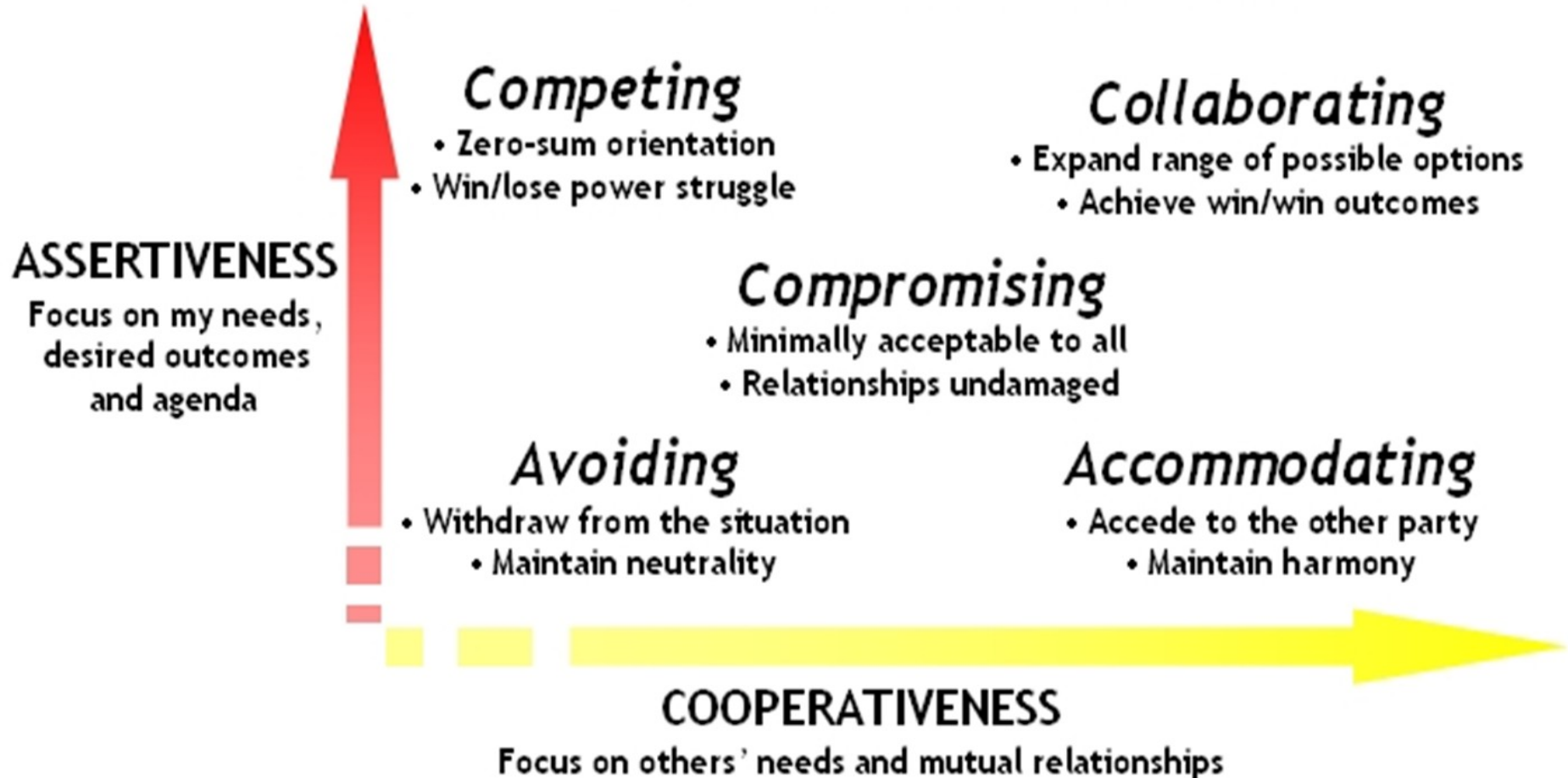
- ✓ Between two or more organizations
- ✓ Not competition
- ✓ Examples: suppliers and distributors, especially with the close links now possible

Conflict Resolution Strategies

- Avoidance (lose-lose situation)
- Compromise (lose-lose situation)
- Competition (win-lose situation)
- Accommodation (Lose -win situation)
- Collaboration (win-win situation)

Conflict Resolution Strategies...

Thomas-Kilmann Conflict Modes



Cont...

AVOID (lose- lose situation)

- ✓ When the issues are trivial, or circumstances dictate that a solution is better left until later.
- ✓ Maybe until you or the other people have calmed down, or reinforcements have arrived.
- ✓ Perhaps it is better to avoid decision making when you are so tired / stressed that your judgment may not be sound
- ✓ When moral or safety issues are involved.
- ✓ Not to be used just because you are afraid to deal with conflict! Issues will only build up and become more complicated.

Cont...

COMPROMISE (lose-lose situation)

- ✓ When the relationship or the issue is important enough to not give it up altogether
- ✓ When both sides strongly believe they are correct and you want each to get nearer their goal, so you come to an agreement by mutual concessions.

Cont...

COMPETITION (win- lose situation)

- ✓ This is when you force the issue to get the decision you want, usually for safety or ethical/ moral/legal issues.
- ✓ Usually involves power struggle ... one end up loosing and the other winning ... but the sum gain is zero because you fail to maintain the relationship

Cont...

ACCOMMODATE (Lose -win situation)

- ✓ There are times when it is most appropriate to “give in,” in a conflict situation.
- ✓ This can occur when for one reason or another you were wrong (possibly you did not have all of the information), or when the other person has legitimate authority.
- ✓ In such circumstances, particularly if you feel strongly about the situation, calmly state your reasons for disagreeing and then “accommodate” with dignity.
- ✓ Again, someone loses you. You need to decide if it is worth it.

Cont...

COLLABORATE (win-win situation)

- ✓ This is the desired goal in all conflict situations
- ✓ Put frustration aside, look at the situation
- ✓ Discuss different viewpoints calmly and professionally
- ✓ Work together so that both happy with the final outcome
- ✓ Negotiate. What are the points you can concede in order to obtain agreement for what is most important. Both sides give and take some until both are satisfied.

Thank you !!